

Reconstruing Educational Innovation

LOUIS M. SMITH

Washington University, St. Louis

JOHN J. PRUNTY

Maritz Communication Company, St. Louis

DAVID C. DWYER

*Far West Laboratory for Educational Research and
Development, San Francisco*

PAUL F. KLEINE

University of Oklahoma, Norman

INTRODUCTION

This article, as the title indicates, presents one of the central conclusions from our recent research on the Kensington Elementary School in the Milford School District. Essentially we want to argue that our early view of the Kensington School was severely limited due to several sets of assumptions we did not make problematic at the time.¹ Second, we argue that our original proposal to the National Institute of Education (NIE) for *Kensington Revisited*, which stated our current "problem," had similar limits.² Third, we argue that one of the most provocative recent summary statements has similar limitations.³ Finally, we want to make the case that our revised position is more clearly in the literature, especially in the work of C. Wright Mills⁴ and Robert Redfield,⁵ than we and others (e.g., Whiteside and Sarason⁶) realized. Most of us who do intensive case-study or qualitative field research recognize a redefinition of a problem, a theoretical reconceptualization, or a reconstrual of a domain as worthy objectives, even though we seldom attain such goals.

This article is based on the project Innovation and Change in American Education—Kensington Revisited: A Fifteen Year Follow-up of an Innovative Elementary School and Its Faculty supported by NIE grant no. G78-0074. The analysis and interpretation represent official policy of neither the National Institute of Education nor the Milford School District. As we have commented on several occasions, the support by Dr. Ronald George, superintendent of Milford, and by Frederick Mulhauser, our NIE project officer, has been overwhelmingly positive at every turn.

In a sense, and after we were underway, Ernie House might be said to have set our task with his integrative “ten year perspective on innovation.”⁷ He argued that three broad perspectives—technological, political, and cultural—have dominated recent thought about educational innovation. In House’s view, the technological model was developed in agriculture and industry and formalized in education as the RD&D model—Research, Development, and Diffusion. It provided the basic set of assumptions for much of the curriculum reform and government effort in educational innovation in the 1960s. The political perspective arose as a competing model and cast the problems and difficulties in changing schools as issues of value pluralism involving multiple interest groups and processes of conflict, negotiation, and compromise in making decisions, securing resources, and distributing incentives and rewards. The cultural perspective took a more holistic and contextualist point of view, usually with concern for the meaning of the actors in the setting. It was an anthropological perspective, frequently carried out by nonanthropologists.

In this context, the part of our study dealing with the life histories of educational innovators and accenting the theme of natural history of belief systems is an attempt to redress the scant attention given to and, in some instances, the complete omission of the individual person in the innovative process. Our *Educational Innovators: Then and Now* (Volume V) accents the biography, the life history of the individuals involved. In a sense it reflects a position among the multiple theories of personality currently in debate in social science and, as a point of view about human personality, can be seen as a kind of psychological perspective. As a psychological perspective it is considerably different both methodologically and substantively from most of the psychological theories and efforts applied to educational innovation. From our viewpoint such a difference is important and constitutes one main contribution of our effort. In effect, we are proposing a fourth perspective to the three raised by House.⁸

Further, we were led into a historical perspective in other parts of our study through a series of serendipitous events, and quite commonsense puzzlements. By chance we stumbled on a closet full of the Milford School District board minutes from 1915 to the present day. They seemed an amazing record of human action and events that illuminated the historical and contemporaneous district context of the Kensington Elementary School. Concomitantly, the change in the makeup of the student body at Kensington School—from 100 percent white in 1964/1965 to 40 percent white and 60 percent black in 1979/1980—led us into demography and the history of community change. We believe now that a historical perspective is very important.

In sum, in our view, an overall model must have technological, political, cultural, biographical, and historical dimensions if the phenomenon of educational innovation is to be understood. That is a part of the reconstrual

for which we are arguing. Twenty-five year ago Mills set such aspirations succinctly:

The sociological imagination enables us to grasp *history* and *biography* and the relations between the two within *society*. That is its task and its promise. To recognize this task and this promise is the mark of the classic social analyst.

No social study that does not come back to the problems of biography, of history and of their intersections within a society has completed its intellectual journey.⁹

Though we are neither sociologists nor “classic social analysts,” our problems and ideas mirror those concerns and our aspirations are in those directions.

THE KENSINGTON-REVISITED CASE STUDY

OVERVIEW

Our research is about innovation and change in American education. It began as *Kensington Revisited: A Fifteen Year Follow-up of an Innovative Elementary School and Its Faculty*,¹⁰ supported by the National Institute of Education. As in most of our case-study research, the initial problem was buffeted about by the reality of settings, events, and people as captured by our several modes of inquiry—participant observation, intensive open-ended interviews, and the collection and analysis of multiple documents. The setting was Kensington, an elementary school built fifteen years ago as a prototypical innovative building with open space, laboratory suites instead of classrooms, a perception core instead of a library, and a nerve center for the latest in educational technology. The ideology was caught in team teaching, individualized curriculum and instruction, and democratic administration. The people were the series of administrators, teachers, pupils, and parents who worked in, attended, or sent their children to the school. Three principals have come and gone, the fourth is in his first year. None of the original faculty remains at the school. Several cadres of faculty have staffed the building. The events were the activities of those people as they built and transformed the school over the years. This story we found, and constructed, as part of a larger setting, the Milford School District, which had its own story, actors, and events and which provided an important context for Kensington.

“Innovation and change in American education” became the guiding theme around which our developing ideas and data could be integrated. That broad rubric is composed of a half dozen subthemes, each of which makes up a separate book-length volume in the final report. While we believe the totality of the study has its own kind of integrity and that each volume extends the meanings of the others, we have written each as a “stand-alone” piece. That is,

we believe each speaks to an important domain of innovation and change in American education, each draws most heavily on a particular subset of our data, and each contains important descriptive narratives and substantive grounded interpretations and generalizations. We present brief summaries of each volume, which are intended, in a few sentences, to keep the totality and each of the pieces in the forefront of the reader's consciousness.

SUBSTANTIVE CONCERNS

Volume I Chronicling the Milford School District: An Historical Context of the Kensington School

Kensington's fifteen-year existence is but one small segment of the Milford School District's sixty-five years of recorded history and one school in a district with a dozen other schools. Stephen Spanman, the superintendent who built the school, is but one of five individuals who have held the post. As we have told the story, we have raised generalizations regarding innovation and change, and have presaged themes of policy; of local, state, and national influences on the school district; of organizational structure and process; and of curriculum and teaching. More abstractly, we moved toward concerns as broad as the many faces of democracy in education and schooling, policymaking and administration, and a longitudinal nested systems model of innovation and change. These are conceptualizations that have been underemphasized in the theory and practice of innovation. The key documents in developing the perspective were the official school board minutes. Newsletters to patrons, newspaper accounts, other records, and interviews, formal and informal, supplemented the basic documents.

Volume II Milford: The School District as Contemporary Context

In a fundamental sense, Volume II is a continuation, a final chapter as it were, of the historical context of the Milford School District. It is a long chapter, however, for the central actors and events that immediately and directly shaped the Kensington School are in place, just as the school is in place. The ebb and flow of the district, in its recent history, is brought to a particular focus, one that will illuminate the events and themes that appear in the development and change in the Kensington School over its fifteen-year history and in its current status. The board of education, the superintendent, the central office staff, and their interrelationships lead toward a governance and organizational perspective on innovation and change. We move finally and more abstractly to a reconsideration of the Griffiths/Greenfield debate¹¹ in the light of our findings regarding the Milford School District as context for the Kensington School innovation. Board minutes remain the central core of the data with increasing amounts of information from public documents (e.g., newspapers), interviews with central actors, and observation of meetings.

Volume III Innovation and Change at Kensington: Annals of a Community and School

This volume begins by tracing the origins and development of a community that became part of the Milford School District in 1949 and a neighborhood that began sending its children to Kensington School in 1964. With the opening of Kensington, the annals of the community are joined by a history of the school. As we develop the stories of Kensington and its neighborhood in tandem, we begin to tell of the interdependency of school and community and to further our understanding of innovation and change in schooling in contemporary American society. Our search for an explanation of the profound changes that have taken place in a once innovative school has pushed us back in time and obliged us to consider such wider topics as demography; ethnic, religious, and racial groups; neighborhoods; and political jurisdiction.

Volume IV Kensington Today: Sailing Stormy Straits, a View of Educational Policy in Action

An ethnographic account of the school today with particular reference to educational policy in action at the day-to-day school level is presented here. The major metaphor is a ship sailing through stormy straits on a perilous journey during the 1979/1980 school year. Staff and students produce vivid scenes reflecting issues in racial integration, special education, discipline, and instruction in basic subjects. Turbulent environments and organizational identity emerge as key conceptions. Policymaking seems analogous to the fine art of navigation.

Volume V Educational Innovators: Then and Now

Crucial to any educational enterprise are the people who staff the schools. Smith and Keith characterized the original faculty of Kensington as true believers.¹² In this volume we sketch life histories; careers; serials of the original faculty based on extended open-ended interviews (2-7 hours); comments by spouses, friends, and colleagues; and various writings—books, brochures, reports, and dissertations. Patterns and themes arise in the form of secular religion, you *do* go home again, organizational niches and career opportunities for educationists, maintenance of educational ideology, continuity and change in personality, and doctoral education—a disaster for reform-oriented practitioners. The natural history of belief systems is the major integrating conception.

Volume VI Case Study Research Methodology: The Intersect of Participant Observation, Historical Method, Life History Research, and Follow-Up Studies

Regularly in our inquiry we have produced methodological appendices to our research reports. We saw our efforts as clarifying the craft of research as we practiced it, ordering its evolving nature, and continuously attempting to integrate it with other ways of knowing. This volume continues in that tradition. Specifically our mode of participant observation now has enlarged itself by a substantial historical thrust and a substantial life-history and biographical thrust. In addition, our research is an instance of a special methodological stance, a follow-up or return to the setting of an earlier major study. In a way it takes on a time-series quality with repeated observations. In doing the descriptive and analytical pieces, Volumes I through V; in reading about how others have done similar work; and in talking with proponents of the various methods we have reached for a broader synthesis of case-study research methods in the intersection of these several approaches. We see all this as an important addition to the methodological literature in educational inquiry in general and to the more specific research tradition in educational innovation.

SUMMARY

In summary, our research is a unique blend of approaches to the problems and issues of innovation and change in American education. It is grounded in the multiple aspects of a single school in a single school district. As in all case studies, the particular events have major meanings for the actors in the setting, but we also believe that these events often capture images and ideas that have relevance for other people in other times and places. These "inner" and "outer" perspectives, which Geertz labeled as "experience-near" and "experience-distant"¹³ conceptions, were part of our early concerns. Even here we found our practices outrunning our initial analytical distinctions. Finally, when we looked back over our shoulders at what we had, we were able to see an intersection of problems, methods, and perspectives. These are contained in Figure 1. In effect we have half a dozen key problems and themes tapped by several major research methods and framed by multiple inner and outer or experience-near and experience-distant perspectives. In each form we hope to be providing mirrors for educationists to see themselves better, that is, more clearly, to be conscious of rephrased problems, and to create more viable options and alternatives. The present article argues that this too is part of a reconstrual of educational innovation.

Volume	Problem/Content/Theme	Major Research Method	Dominant Perspective/ Point of View
I	Genesis and Evolution of a School District	Historical	Natural History
II	Innovation and Its Contemporary Context	Historical	Board of Education/ Central Administration
III	Community and Neighborhood Change	Historical	Minority Population
IV	Kensington Today/ Policy Implications	Ethnography	Liberal Reformer
V	Faculty Careers/ Life History of True Believers	Life History	Participants/ Outside Theorists
VI	Theory of Methodology	Analytic/ Reflective	Researchers

Figure 1: An Overview of Kensington Revisited:
Intersection of Problems, Methods, and Perspectives

ARGUMENTS FOR A RECONSTRUAL

HISTORY

In an earlier circulation of one of the historical volumes of the extended report we had reactions and comments regarding the need for such an intensive history of the Milford School District. In a sense we were asked, What is the question to which that long monograph was the answer? We built a perspective that culminated in the phrasing of that question.

Several beliefs coalesced in our view. First, we thought that most educational innovators and researchers of educational innovation had not taken up the issues in the relationship between educational innovation and educational change. Very simply put, we see educational innovation as a specific planned improvement. As such it is just one class of phenomena in the larger category of educational change. When viewed in this larger context, innovation takes on considerably different meaning. Our hunch is that most innovators have been so busy with their own specific problems and programs that they have not pursued the implications of events occurring in the larger category. As we thought about these issues, other related concepts entered our analysis. Educational reform became a major or large-scale innovation often blended with idealism. Utopias seemed to be extreme kinds of reforms. Other concepts of change seemed to imply other assumptions or root metaphors. For

instance, the genesis of a school district is a specific kind of innovation with a time referent. The evolution of a district implies gradual change over a period of time. Growth and decline suggest change in size and perhaps an evaluative disclaimer. In American culture, growth is bigger and better and decline is smaller and lesser. Clustered, these concepts also implied a more organismic or naturalistic metaphor. Other concepts used by people involved in educational innovation—for example, expansion, contraction, reorganization, and merger—although not mutually exclusive of our early classes of terms, seem to fit more comfortably a technical perspective and, perhaps, imply a more mechanistic root metaphor, as Pepper argues.¹⁴ Our point is simple: The very language one uses to talk about change in schools and schooling brings major and usually implicit “excess baggage” or meanings into the discussion.

For the moment, we settled on the outline in Figure 2, a beginning analytical context for the concept of educational innovation. As we worked through the data and analysis in volumes I, II, and III, the history of the changing school district and community helped us “see” the nature of Kensington School as an educational innovation, a specific planned change. The magnitude of this insight on change is caught in the restatement of the overall title of our study. What began as *Kensington Revisited: A Fifteen Year Follow-up of an Innovation Elementary School and Its Faculty* has become *Innovation and Change in American Education*, with the original wording now a subtitle.

1. Educational change—the general category
2. Change from a “planned” perspective
 - 2.1 Innovation
 - 2.2 Reform
 - 2.3 Utopia
3. Change from a “naturalistic” perspective
 - 3.1 Genesis
 - 3.2 Evolution
 - 3.3 Growth
 - 3.4 Decline
4. Change from a “technical” perspective
 - 4.1 Expansion—add on
 - 4.2 Contraction—subtract
 - 4.3 Differentiation
 - 4.4 Reorganization
 - 4.5 Merger

Figure 2. A Beginning Analytical Context of the Concept “Innovation”

Our history of the growing, evolving, changing Milford School District helped us see more clearly a related set of issues, the political context of innovation. If educational innovation is only one kind of change and if it is, as colloquially expressed, your or my "baby," that is, attached to someone's political interests—as often is the case, and was in Milford—then a further idea follows. At a minimum, other individuals may have other interests and ideas they see as desirable, special, and, possibly, innovative. If their ideas are not perfectly congruent with yours or mine then we begin to have a problem of priorities, resources, power, and persuasion. In short, your or my innovation may well be just one small part of a political process. Goodness and truth may not lie in your or my project to the degree we had assumed. At this point, our specific planned change is more than a technical or scientific problem. Illuminating that cluster of events, the give-and-take of conflict, compromise, and political maneuvering became very important to us.

Third, it is our belief that many if not most educational innovators do not know much educational history. We believe that this is a tragedy for them and their ideas and a tragedy for many of the individuals in the schools on which they "inflict" their innovations, for example, new open-space buildings, individualized curriculum and instruction, or democratic administration. This belief is one of the major results of our study. As one of our colleagues commented on listening to our enthusiasm and stories, "Lou, you've discovered history." And so we have. This concern for history in general and for history of the Milford District in particular is part of a major shift in our concept of paradigms or root metaphors underlying our approach to educational research, theory, and practice. We feel we are operating from a contextualist metaphor as Pepper¹⁵ and Sarbin¹⁶ use the term. With them, we believe the power of social science and educational inquiry will be enhanced as others move in this direction also.

Fourth, even so, there is still enough of the natural scientist in each of us to feel that an outsider's reasonably detached view of the "natural history" of a or, better, *this* school district might be more important than just the pursuit of idle curiosity. We believe that the genesis and evolution of the district from this more naturalistic perspective shades into our more contextualist perspective. As such, we can view "the new elementary education of Kensington" as one superintendent's vision, in a history of five superintendents and seventy-five years of schooling in Milford. Where does that superintendent, Spanman, fit in the evolution of the Milford School District? Where did he come from? Why did he build the innovative Kensington School here?

Fifth, when we accidentally fell into the huge body of data, bound volumes of Milford board minutes reaching back to 1915, the practicality and possibility of this historical dimension became a reality. Beyond a Mount Everest being there to be climbed, we have found that vague, general, and often ill-founded ideas take on another kind of vitality when they are moved into the concrete

reality of data on human events. As we argue elsewhere,¹⁷ school board minutes are public records of an unusual sort. Finding a closet full of them opened up unimagined vistas. The historical context was there.

Sixth, one of the truisms in our field research is that “the problem” evolves over the course of the project. This is the best of what is sometimes called responsive research design rather than preset research design. Rather than being a producer of anxiety, this becomes part of the excitement and joy of the unexpected in field research.

In short, Volume I, *Chronicling the Milford School District: An Historical Context of the Kensington School*, is just that, a historical context. Volumes II and III extend that context. They answer the question “Where does the Kensington School as an innovation fit into the larger picture?” Because this picture is treated historically as the genesis and evolution of a school district it permits us to deal with the broader reconceptualization or phrasing of our problem as “innovation and change in American education.” By introducing “American” into the statement we have gone from the instance of the Milford School District to a larger class or category of events, “American education.” And that is a major issue in its own right. We believe that one of the best ways, although not the only way, of understanding that larger set of events is to know intimately one highly detailed but integrated case. With such an image at hand, one can begin to come to terms with any other case and with the larger category. As we commented in jest with the current superintendent of Milford, “We know more about Milford than anyone ever has known and probably more than anyone will want to know.” That is, unless one wants to “really” understand innovation and change in American education. Such is the question, and hope, of these historical volumes in the overall report.

LIFE HISTORY

The argument for a life-history component of educational innovation has been with us implicitly since our labeling of the Kensington teachers as “true believers,” after Hoffer’s use of the term,¹⁸ men and women of fanatical faith willing to die for a cause. In *Anatomy of Educational Innovation* we did not make this issue problematic in the sense either of asking for the reasons these individuals chose to come to the Milford School District or of asking about the genesis of such a personal point of view. Now our speculations run in multiple directions. For instance, if educational innovators differ from educational reformers only in the size of the planned change they contemplate, and if both are linked with being true believers, and if educational reform has a quality of secularized religion, as we have argued in the main report, then the phenomenon of educational innovation has roots well beyond a simple technological, cost-benefit, or surface change in schooling practices. More specifically, our hypothesis of educational reform as secular religion grew out of our surprise at finding religious views and

experiences entangled in multiple ways in the backgrounds and beliefs of our group from Kensington. Several had trained for the ministry; many, both men and women, were quite active as Sunday school teachers with adult groups; one had become a born-again Christian. These ideas, with others, have broadened into a theme we call "the natural history of belief systems." Our results suggest that beliefs about innovation are not simple, peripheral, fly-by-night add-ons to the personalities of educational innovators.

To return to our data and interpretations, our study of life histories argues that theories of educational innovation must include other concepts and propositions about the personality of the innovators. "Proactive" is a term that runs through multiple levels of abstraction regarding innovation. At a concrete situational level our people tended to be planning, choosing, self-determining people who looked for, found, and got into situations supportive of their positions. Theoretically it argues for a theory-of-action alternative to more reactive, behavioristic positions. Paradigmatically such terms take a stance on root metaphors—contextualist versus mechanical. In short, the domain of educational innovation requires a place for life history as a special perspective on personality theory.

Major life events—schools, peer networks, jobs, marriages, and deaths in one's family—are the class of variables influencing belief systems and personality styles. Our interests have been rekindled in concepts such as developmental tasks and have been moved toward creating ideas such as "experiential funnel," which captures the long-term channeling of experiences and resultant belief systems.

These issues of biography, life history, and personality, while significant in their own right, seem especially important as one moves along the continuum or across the domains of educational change from educational innovation to educational reform to educational utopian idealism. Critiquing, rewriting, or extending Matson's *Idea of Man*¹⁹ is not on our agenda now, although that is what is called for as we look at life-history implications for educational innovation. As we have detailed elsewhere,²⁰ our data have pushed us a long way on the road away from mechanistic or biological images of human nature. Matson's "creator image," the person as free agent, as creative actor on the world stage, whose existence is open-ended and characterized "by choice, contingency, and chance,"²¹ is the direction in which we find ourselves going. Such a perspective raises questions with many of the assumptions underlying much of academic psychology, and, in our view, represents a part of a basic paradigmatic shift in social science.²² This, also, is a part of the needed reconstrual of educational innovation.

CONCLUSION: REDISCOVERING ROBERT REDFIELD

We have indicated that C. Wright Mills was "already there," while we were stumbling along.²³ An even more fully differentiated position is that of Robert

Redfield in *The Little Community*.²⁴ If one approaches Redfield analogically, that is, if one looks at a school or school district as a little community, then one can bring his distinctions to bear on the problems of educational innovation. Briefly, in his low-key phrasing:

This book is about some of the several ways in which the organized life of man can be viewed and understood. The subject is the forms of thought for understanding humanity; it is a book about "method," if one means by that word not merely the techniques of observation and analysis, but also the conceptions which allow us to characterize and compare.²⁵

Later, he seems to finish the thought:

We shall be required, then, as we proceed, to accustom ourselves to thinking at two levels. First, we look at an Indian or African village or a peasant settlement, and we think about it. We think about it, as far as we are able, as a whole. We find what there is to say about all of it. And then we turn to the form of thought we have used in thinking about it so, and we think about this thought. The kinds of thinking about communities as wholes become the second and derivative subject matter of these chapters. This is an invitation to consider the mental apparatus for characterizing human societies.²⁶

In a sentence or two we try to capture Redfield's distinctions and the flavor of his approach. Perhaps most significant is the formatting or the grammar of his book, that is, "the little community as: . . ." with each chapter providing an alternative perspective.

His first chapter accents the holistic/analytic controversy and he puts himself fully in the tradition seeking syntheses. His next holistic perspective, "An Ecological System," accents the community's relationship to its environment, particularly the physical environment. Later, in Chapter 7, "A Community within Communities," he turns to the community's relationship to its multiple social environments. Other holistic social scientists have accented such issues in a concern for the group's survival in its environment.²⁷ Redfield's "social structure" perspective (Chapter 3) accents the ahistorical, cross-sectional relationships of the parts of communities. It is the structural/functionalist set of concepts and issues that has dominated much of social anthropology over the last seventy-five years. Positions, statuses, roles, make up structures that in turn make up systems.

Redfield then develops three lines of discussion that parallel many of the ideas raised by our life-history concerns. Chapter 4, a "typical biography," presents the human career characteristic of a community, and leads easily into Chapter 5, "a kind of person," and from this view of a modal or prototypical person he moves to the ethos or "an outlook on life." In his view this is the

domain of the philosophers. Life histories, modal personalities, and value systems woven together create a powerful lens for looking at the little community and, metaphorically, at innovative schooling. If we had seen all that clearly earlier, we would have moved differently. Chapter 7 raises "a history," and probes the problems and issues in history and ethnography. As we have indicated, we think we did better here than we had any right to expect.

The last two chapters of Redfield's book seem to shift toward another level of discourse: "a combination of opposites" and "whole and parts." Dialectic thought, the "this" on the one hand and the "that" on the other, vies with internal and external dialogue. Finally, he is back to fundamental issues in the mental structures for considering parts and wholes and carrying out specific research projects. In part, these are issues of figure and ground and the productive ways in which a social scientist can shift back and forth. Into this discussion comes again the vantage point taken by the researcher. As illustrated in Figure 2, we found and took multiple positions across the volumes and topics of our report. In Redfield's view readers will bring additional and different perspectives to the accounts as written.

Through these multiple views run a number of polarities, dichotomies, and dilemmas existing in today's literature: structural versus processual conceptions, historical versus contemporaneous context, inner versus outer view, portrayal versus analytical view, understanding versus action purposes, real versus ideal conceptions, and dialectical thought versus part-whole thought versus analytical thought. These, in our view, are the issues at a tertiary or meta level.²⁸ Most significantly, Redfield is simultaneously anticipating, speaking to, and suggesting practical alternatives regarding the paradigmatic crisis in education and the social sciences. These items are in the domain in which the most abstract reconstrual of educational innovation will occur.

Our thesis in this article is relatively simple. We believe that the phenomenon of educational innovation needs to be reconstrued. We concur with House that most of the theory and practice has been from technological, political, or cultural perspectives. These are important; however, we believe that history and life-history approaches would add significantly to the discussion of educational innovation. Well after we were into our own empirical effort we found the work of Mills and Redfield provocative in their call for multiple interrelated perspectives in social science inquiry. Our strong emphasis on fitting the Kensington innovation into the history of the Milford School District and the Milford community, and our strong emphasis on the life histories of the faculty and administration, have been coupled with a detailed history and ethnography of the school itself. That, we think, is a powerful way of looking at educational innovation. Our hope is that the multiple perspectives, methods, and data from *Kensington Revisited* give a concrete, particularistic case for entertaining the needed reconstrual.

Notes

- 1 L. M. Smith and P. Keith, *Anatomy of Educational Innovation* (New York: John Wiley, 1971).
- 2 L. Smith, *Kensington Revisited: A Fifteen Year Follow-up of an Innovative Elementary School and Its Faculty, Original Proposal* (Washington, D.C.: NIE, 1977).
- 3 E. House, "Technology as Craft: A Ten-Year Perspective on Innovation," *Journal of Curriculum Studies* 11 (1979): 1-15.
- 4 C. W. Mills, *The Sociological Imagination* (London: Oxford University Press, 1959).
- 5 R. Redfield, *The Little Community* (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 1955).
- 6 T. Whiteside, *The Sociology of Educational Innovation* (London: Methuen, 1978); S. Sarason, *The Creation of Settings and the Future Societies* (San Francisco: Jossey-Bass, 1971); and idem, *The Culture of the School and the Problem of Change*, 2nd ed. (Boston: Allyn and Bacon, 1982).
- 7 House, "Technology as Craft," p. 1.
- 8 Ibid.
- 9 Mills, *The Sociological Imagination*, p. 6.
- 10 L. M. Smith, J. J. Prunty, D. C. Dwyer, and P. F. Kleine. *Kensington Revisited: A Fifteen Year Follow-up of an Innovative Elementary School and Its Faculty*, vol. 1-6 (Washington, D. C.: NIE, 1984).
- 11 Daniel Griffiths, "Intellectual Turmoil in Educational Administration," *Educational Administration Quarterly* 15 (1979): 43-65; and Thomas B. Greenfield, "Reflections on Organizational Theory and the Truth of Irreconcilable Realities," *Educational Administration Quarterly* 14 (1978): 43-65.
- 12 Smith and Keith, *Anatomy of Educational Innovation*.
- 13 C. Geertz, *The Interpretation of Cultures* (New York: Basic Books, 1973).
- 14 S. Pepper, *World Hypotheses: A Study in Evidence* (Berkeley: University of California Press, 1942).
- 15 Ibid.
- 16 T. R. Sarbin, "Contextualism: A World View for Modern Psychology," in *Personal Construct Psychology, Nebraska Symposium on Motivation 1976*, ed. J. Cole (Lincoln: University of Nebraska Press, 1977).
- 17 Smith et al., *Kensington Revisited*, vol. 6.
- 18 E. Hoffer, *The True Believer* (New York: Mentor, 1951).
- 19 F. W. Matson, *The Idea of Man* (New York: Delacorte Press, 1976).
- 20 Smith et al., *Kensington Revisited*, vol. 6.
- 21 Matson, *The Idea of Man*, pp. xiii-xxii.
- 22 R. Bernstein, *The Restructuring of Social and Political Theory* (Philadelphia: University of Pennsylvania Press, 1978); B. Fay, *Social Theory and Political Practice* (London: George Allen and Unwin, 1975); and E. Bredo and W. Feinberg, ed., *Knowledge and Values in Social and Educational Research* (Philadelphia: Temple University Press, 1982).
- 23 Mills does not cite Redfield's *The Little Community*. Our search indicates that he is not in the cognitive map of most educational innovators, nor even most educational anthropologists—if one looks at citations.
- 24 Much of Redfield's thinking seems stirred by the catastrophic impact of Oscar Lewis's restudy of Tepoztlán (Oscar Lewis, *Tepoztlán* [Champaign: University of Illinois Press, 1951]).
- 25 Redfield, *The Little Community*, p. 1.
- 26 Ibid., p. 16.
- 27 G. C. Homans, *The Human Group* (New York: Harcourt, Brace and World, 1950); and F. Emery and E. Trist, *Towards a Social Ecology* (London: Plenum, 1975).
- 28 L. M. Smith, "An Evolving Logic of Participant Observation, Educational Ethnography and Other Case Studies," in *Review of Research in Education* 6, ed. L. Shulman (Itasca, Ill.: Peacock, 1979).